Project Close-out

Finish well: check what was achieved, hand over cleanly, capture what you learned, tie up loose ends and say thank you.

Run a Project · Close · Benefits Realisation · Lessons Learned

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

PROJECT: *Reorder made easy*

DATE: *4 July*

1 Did We Achieve It?

AGAINST THE ORIGINAL GOAL

Original goal: *weekly repeat orders 22% → 30%, reordering under a minute*

What we delivered: *one-tap reorder, substitutes, order history, reminders*

MEASURE	TARGET	ACTUAL	WHAT IT TELLS US
Weekly repeat orders	*30%*	*29%*	*nearly there; still rising*
Median basket time	*10 min*	*12 min*	*reorder users: 3 min*
Second order within 2 days	*5%*	*6%*	*substitutes helped most*

2 Benefits Still to Come

MOST VALUE ARRIVES AFTER THE PROJECT ENDS

BENEFIT	EXPECTED BY	MEASURED HOW	OWNER
Repeat orders reach 30%	*end of Q3*	*weekly dashboard*	*Priya*
Fewer missing-item calls	*September*	*call reason codes*	*Customer service*
Lower cost per order	*Q4*	*Finance report*	*Finance*
Subscriptions pilot decision	*6 June ✓*	*pilot results*	*Head of Digital*

3 Handover

WHO OWNS IT NOW?

- [x] Support team trained and ready
- [x] Documentation and runbooks handed over
- [x] Open defects and backlog given an owner
- [x] Monitoring and alerts owned
- [x] Access, licences and accounts sorted
- [ ] Contracts and suppliers closed
- [x] Budget closed and reported

Handed to: *Basket team (it's their product now)*

4 What We Learned

FOR THE NEXT PROJECT, NOT FOR THE ARCHIVE

KEEP DOING

- *Slicing thin and releasing weekly*
- *Example Mapping before planning*
- *Pairing on payments code*

DO DIFFERENTLY

- *Agree dependencies at big-room planning*
- *Name an owner for shared code early*
- *Start the privacy sign-off in week 1*

SURPRISES

- *How fast customers took to reorder*
- *How much time sign-offs cost*

5 Loose Ends

NOTHING LEFT WITHOUT AN OWNER

ITEM	OWNER	BY WHEN
Retire the old reorder email	*Mei*	*end of July*
Close the analytics test account	*Sam*	*15 July*
Hand the stock replica adapter to Warehouse	*Sam*	*when the API ships*

6 Thanks & Celebrate

People and teams to thank: *Store Ops, Payments, Warehouse, Platform*

the customer panel, and the pilot-store pickers

How we'll celebrate: *team lunch, and a thank-you at the all-hands*

Share the story and lessons with: *the other product groups, at the showcase*

"What would we tell the next team that runs a project like this?"

"Who will check the benefits arrived, and when?"

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